

**A320**

- 1967** The UK, France, and Germany sign a Memorandum of Understanding on future commercial aircraft cooperation.
- 1970** The multinational Airbus Industrie consortium is formed.
- 1972** In October, the Airbus A300 makes its first flight.
- 1974** The Airbus A300 enters service with Air France in May.
- 1978** Eastern Airlines places a significant order for 23 A300s.

**A340**

- 1982** In April, the smaller Airbus A310 flies for the first time. Airbus A300 deliveries hit an annual peak of 46.
- 1988** The world's first "fly-by-wire" airliner, the Airbus A320, enters service.
- 1991** Airbus's first four jet-engined airliner, the A340, makes its first flight.
- 1992** The twin-jet Airbus A330 takes its maiden flight.
- 1999** Airbus Military is established, specifically to develop and produce aircraft for military service.

**A380**

- 2000** The Airbus A3XX program is commercially launched.
- 2002** The smallest Airbus, the 107/117-seat A318, has its first flight.
- 2003** The A310 MRTT tanker/transport flies.
- 2005** The first A380, the world's largest airliner, takes off from Toulouse for the first time.
- 2007** The A330 MRTT tanker/transport's first flight takes place in June. The first A380 is delivered to launch customer Singapore Airlines in October.

**A400M Atlas**

- 2009** The Airbus A400M has its first flight.
- 2011** The A330 MRTT refueling tanker is named Voyager. Although not chosen by the USAF, it wins contracts with air forces worldwide.
- 2012** The A400M, Airbus's flagship military transport, is named Atlas, with six aircraft on the flight test program.
- 2013** The first Airbus A350XWB is rolled out at Toulouse, France.
- 2016** The wide-body A320neo (new engine option) family is introduced.

“We showed the world that we were not sitting on a nine-day wonder”

JEAN ROEDER, CEO OF DEUTSCHE AIRBUS, ON THE A310

In 1994, work began on a program to build a competitor to Boeing's market-dominating 747. At the end of 2000, the double-deck 555/853-seat A380 program was formally launched and, in April 2005, the prototype was flown. By this time, Airbus Industrie had been replaced by Airbus SAS, which became part of the EADS

(European Aeronautic Defense and Space Company) corporation. BAE Systems sold its stake in Airbus to EADS in 2006, leaving Airbus entirely

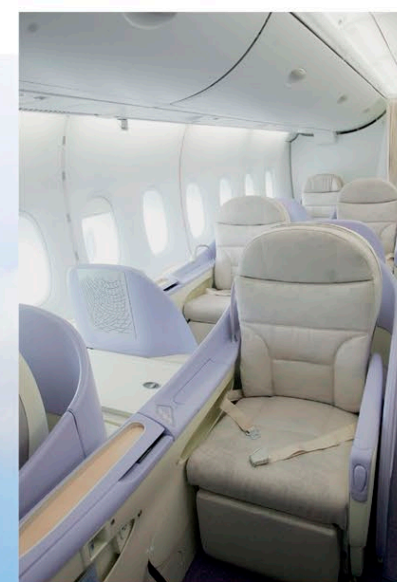
owned by EADS. The A380 entered commercial service with Singapore Airlines in October 2007 as the world's largest airliner.

Airbus's challenger to Boeing's 787 Dreamliner, the A350XWB, had its first flight in 2013. By this time, the Airbus A400M Atlas had also gone into military service. The four-turboprop aircraft is Airbus Military's flagship product. After a protracted period of development, its maiden flight was achieved in December 2009. By August 2012, the aircraft had been given the name Atlas, and 174 were on order by seven air forces.

In 2019, nearly five decades after its creation, Airbus overtook Boeing to become the world's largest aircraft manufacturer. While the A380 was not a success, and production was wound down in 2020, the A320 series goes from strength to strength.

Airbus A380-800

The "superjumbo" Airbus A380 first entered service in 2007. It can carry up to 853 passengers on two decks.



Premium cabins aboard the A380

For customers seeking luxury, the comfort of a partly enclosed area with a leather seat and single bed is an option. Some A380s also have shower spas and lounge areas.

